GLASSHOUSE EARTHWORKS

TRANSFORMING LANDSCAPES, BUILDING DREAMS

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT (SWMS)

Activity: Basic Excavation & Soil Removal (Single Operator or Dual Operator)

1. Administrative Details

Company Name:	**Glasshouse Earthworks**	**ABN: 75 636 496 655**
Operator Name:	Mitchell Brown	**Contact:** 0407 753 558
Project Address:	1 Aquatic Centre Dr, Burpengary QLD 4505	**Date Prepared:** 24/03/2026
Principal Contractor:	Tallan Group	**Date Provided to PC: 24/03/2026**

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2. High Risk Construction Work (HRCW) Identified

Check all that apply to this specific job. These triggers require a SWMS under QLD WHS Reg s291.

- **Movement of powered mobile plant** (Excavators, skid steers, tip trucks)
- **Work in or near a trench/shaft >1.5m deep** (Requires specific battering/shoring controls)
- Work near energised electrical installations (Overhead or underground)
- Work on or near a road or railway (Traffic management required)

3. PPE & Equipment Requirements

- **Mandatory PPE:** Steel cap boots, High-Vis clothing, Sun protection (hat, long sleeves).
- **Plant Used:** 5T Excavator, 8T excavator Posi Track, Tipper Truck.
- **Permits/Checks:** Plans available, General Construction Induction (White Card).

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4. Risk Assessment & Control Measures

Risk Rating Matrix: L (Low), M (Medium), H (High), E (Extreme)

Step / Activity	Hazards (What can go wrong?)	Risk (Pre)	Control Measures (How you will stay safe)	Responsibility
1. Planning & Site Arrival	- Unauthorised access - Unaware of site rules - Traffic collision	M	- Complete site induction with Principal Contractor (if applicable). - Establish an **Exclusion Zone** (3m radius). - Positive Comms	Operator
2. Unloading Plant	- Plant rollover - Crushing bystanders - Plant failure	H	- Park truck on level ground before unloading. - Use a spotter if reversing into blind spots. - Ensure ramps are secure and rated for machine weight. - **No-Go Zone:** No pedestrians within swing radius while unloading.	Operator
3. Pre-Start Checks	- Hydraulic failure - Brake failure - Safety guards missing	M	- Conduct daily pre-start check (oil, coolant, tracks, bucket pins, beacon, squawker). - Ensure fire extinguisher is in cabin and charged. - Test standard bucket/attachments for security.	Operator
4. Locating Services	- **Electrocution (Strike)** - Gas explosion - Water burst	**E**	- **Visual Inspection:** Look for pits, meters, and overhead lines. - **Potholing:** Use hand tools (shovel) or hydro-vac to positively identify assets before mechanical digging. - Maintain minimum approach distances (e.g., 500mm for low voltage - check QLD Electrical Safety Code).	Operator
5. Excavation Operations	- Trench collapse (>1.5m) - Dust/Silica exposure - Striking structures	H	- **Collapse:** If trench >1.5m, bench, batter (1:1), or shore walls according to engineering advice (QLD Excavation Code 2021). - **Dust:** Wet down soil if generating excessive dust; keep cab door closed; wear	Operator

			P2 mask if silica risk exists. - **Ops:** Operator to remain in seat with seatbelt on. Stop work immediately if anyone enters the exclusion zone.	
6. Soil Removal (Loading Truck)	- Falling debris - Truck driver injury - Overloading	H	- **Communication:** Establish eye contact/radio comms with truck driver before loading. - **Driver Safety:** Truck driver must remain in cab or in a designated safe zone (away from the truck) while loading. - Do not swing bucket over the truck cabin. - Load evenly to prevent truck instability.	Operator / Truck Driver
7. Site Clean Up & Departure	- Tripping hazards - Environmental contamination - Unsecured load	M	- Backfill or fence off any open holes left overnight. - Clean tracks before driving onto public road (prevent mud tracking). - Secure machine to trailer/truck using load-rated chains and dogs. - Lower all attachments to the deck for transport.	Operator

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5. Emergency Response

Emergency	**Action**
Service Strike (Gas/Power)	1. Stop work immediately. 2. Do not exit machine if power line is touched (unless fire). Hop away with feet together if forcing exit. 3. Call 000 and the Asset Owner (e.g., Energex/Ergon) immediately.
Injury	1. Secure scene (turn off machine). 2. Administer First Aid. 3. Notify Principal Contractor.
Site Address:	1 Aquatic Centre Dr, Burpengary QLD 4505
Nearest Hospital:	87/129 McKean St, Caboolture QLD 4510

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6. Operator Sign-Off

have read and understood this SWMS and will work in accordance with these control measures.

Name	Signature	Date
Mitchell Brown		24/3/26
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